

Tata Steel

HOLD

Strong India Performance; UK Weakness Persists

Summary

Tata Steel's Q3FY26 performance was above our expectations. Revenue fell 3% QoQ to Rs570bn, driven by 4% QoQ increase in volumes, aided by strong growth in India operations. This was offset by a 6% QoQ decrease in realizations owing to weak steel prices. Consolidated EBITDA declined 11% QoQ to Rs82bn, with EBITDA/t declining 11% QoQ to Rs9,987. UK operations saw EBITDA loss widen to Rs14,199/t in Q3FY26 from Rs13,510/t in Q2FY26 owing to subdued demand and pricing. The Netherland business posted EBITDA of Rs4,068/t, down from Rs5,948/t in Q2FY26 amid pressure from regulatory burdens. The cost transformation program achieved Rs86Bn in cost saving during 9MFY26. We roll over to FY28E estimate and assign an EV/EBITDA multiple of 7.5x to FY28E EBITDA to derive target price of Rs223 and maintain HOLD rating on the stock.

Key Highlights and Investment Rationale

- Strong volumes growth in Indian operations:** Revenue from Indian operations increased 3% QoQ to Rs357bn, driven by a 9% QoQ rise in sales volumes to 6.04mn tonnes, making the highest quarterly sales volume. However, realization declined 6% QoQ to Rs59,147 per tonne, owing to weak HRC prices. Consequently, EBITDA per tonne decreased by 12% QoQ to Rs13,735/t due to lower realisations. Management expects the coking coal costs to be higher by \$15 in Q4FY26, following the recent price increase.
- Major Drag from European Operations:** UK operations witnessed a 9% QoQ decline in volumes, while realizations improved by 2% QoQ, resulting in a 7% QoQ fall in revenue to Rs 55.3bn. As a result, EBITDA/t loss increased by 5% QoQ to Rs14,199/t. Sales volume in Netherlands decreased 9% QoQ and realisations decreased by 2% QoQ, leading to an 11% QoQ decrease in revenue. The performance was mainly impacted due to US trade barriers, adverse product mix, negative contract renegotiations and regulatory burdens.

TP **Rs223**

CMP **Rs197**

Potential upside/downside 13%

Previous Rating HOLD

Price Performance (%)

	-1m	-3m	-12m
Absolute	9.4	8.6	42.5
Rel to Sensex	10.1	8.2	35.1

V/s Consensus

EBITDA (Rs bn)	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
IDBI Capital	351	426	450
Consensus	347	419	450
% difference	1.3	1.7	(0.0)

Key Stock Data

Bloomberg / Reuters	TATA IN / TISC.BO
Sector	Metal & Mining
Shares o/s (mn)	12,483
Market cap. (Rs mn)	24,59,865
3-m daily average value (Rs mn)	238.6
52-week high / low	Rs203 / 123
Sensex / Nifty	83,580 / 25,694

Shareholding Pattern (%)

Promoters	33.2
FII	17.5
DII	25.0
Public	24.3

Financial snapshot

Year	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	2,292	2,185	2,386	2,566	2,760
Change (yoy, %)	(5.8)	(4.6)	9.2	7.6	7.6
EBITDA	223	253	351	426	450
Change (yoy, %)	(30.9)	13.4	38.6	21.5	5.6
EBITDA Margin(%)	9.7	11.6	14.7	16.6	16.3
Adj.PAT	34	43	130	171	187
EPS (Rs)	2.7	3.4	10.4	13.7	15.0
Change (yoy, %)	(61.8)	26.6	203.4	31.5	9.8
PE(x)	72.8	57.5	19.0	14.4	13.1
Dividend Yield (%)	1.8	1.8	1.9	1.9	1.9
EV/EBITDA (x)	14.5	13.0	9.2	7.4	6.8
RoE (%)	3.5	4.7	13.0	15.3	14.9
RoCE (%)	5.9	7.1	11.0	13.7	13.9

Source: IDBI Capital Research

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Exhibit 1: Quarterly Snapshot

(Rs mn)

Financial snapshot	Q3FY26	Q2FY26	QoQ (%)	Q3FY25	YoY (%)
Net Sales	5,70,024	5,86,893	(2.9)	5,36,483	6.3
Total expenditure	4,88,027	4,97,928	(2.0)	4,77,448	2.2
EBITDA	81,997	88,965	(7.8)	59,035	38.9
<i>EBITDA margin (%)</i>	<i>14.4%</i>	<i>15.2%</i>	<i>-77bps</i>	<i>11.0%</i>	<i>338bps</i>
EBITDA/t	9,987	11,247	(11.2)	7,647	30.6
Interest	17,473	17,750	(1.6)	18,041	(3.1)
Depreciation	30,488	28,930	5.4	25,692	18.7
PBT	38,688	45,921	(15.8)	16,720	131.4
Tax	11,384	10,394	9.5	13,765	(17.3)
Reported PAT	26,887	31,018	(13.3)	3,266	723.1
Adjusted PAT	28,286	35,222	(19.7)	4,528	524.6
Diluted EPS	2.3	2.8	(19.7)	0.4	524.6

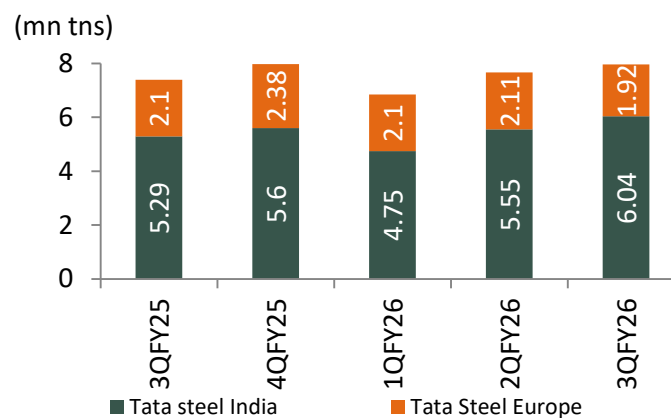
Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 2: Actual vs estimates

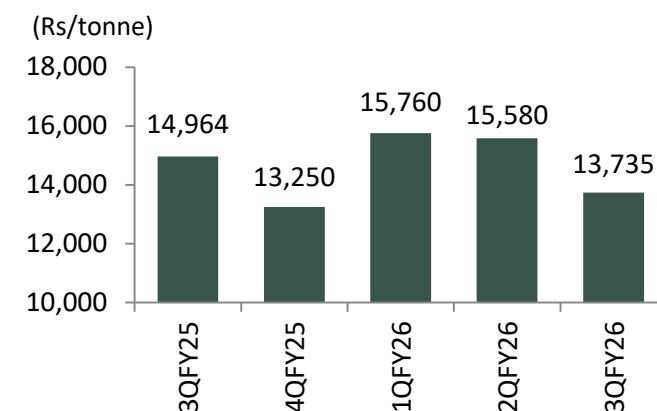
(Rs mn)

	Q3FY26E	Q3FY26A	% Variance
Net sales	5,57,527	5,70,024	2.2
EBTIDA	76,376	81,997	7.4
<i>Margin (%)</i>	<i>13.7</i>	<i>14.4</i>	<i>69bps</i>
PAT	22,909	28,286	23.5
Dil. EPS	1.8	2.3	23.5

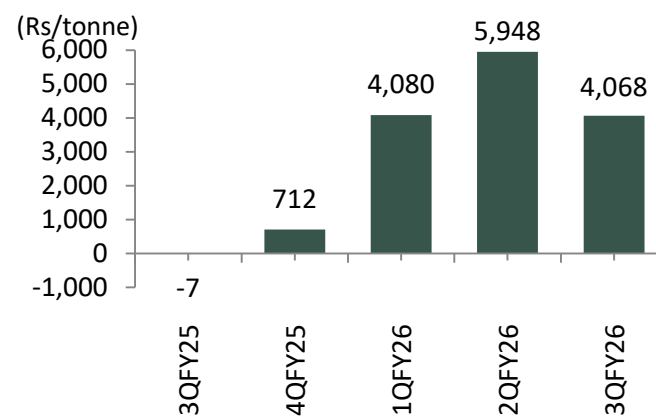
Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 3: Geographical sales mix

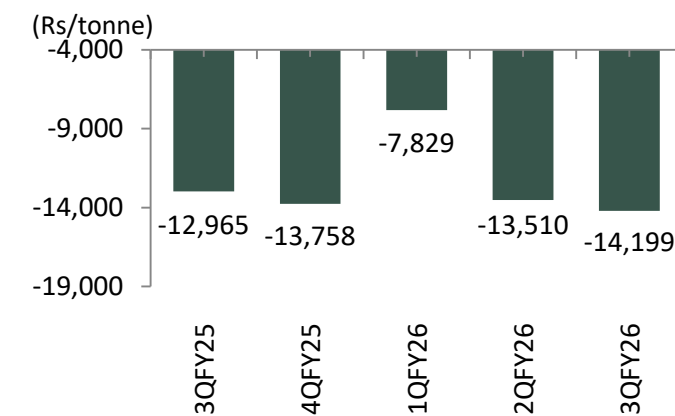
Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 4: EBITDA/tonne - India Operations

Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 5: EBITDA/tonne - Netherlands Operations

Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 6: EBITDA/tonne - UK Operations

Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Exhibit 7: Change in estimates

	FY26E			FY27E			FY28E
	Old	New	(%) Chg	Old	New	(%) Chg	New
Revenue (Rs bn)	2,386	2,386	(0.0)	2,629	2,566	(2.4)	2,760
EBITDA (Rs bn)	351	351	(0.0)	389	426	9.5	450
<i>EBITDA margin (%)</i>	<i>14.7</i>	<i>14.7</i>	<i>0bps</i>	14.8	16.6	<i>180bps</i>	16.3
Adj. Net profit (Rs bn)	103	130	26.4	124	171	37.8	187
Adj. EPS (Rs)	8.2	10.4	26.4	9.9	13.7	37.8	15.0

Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

Conference call highlights

Financial Performance & Liquidity

- EBITDA margins expanded by 300 basis points to 15%, reflecting disciplined execution despite global macro uncertainty and high Chinese exports.
- The company generated an operating cash flow of Rs20,500 crores (9M FY26) and significantly reduced net debt to Rs81,834 crores, down by Rs5,200 crores from the previous quarter.
- The net debt to EBITDA ratio stands at 2.6x, well within the target range of 3.0x.

India Operations & Market Leadership

- India remains the core growth driver; crude steel production rose 12% to 6.34 million tons, and quarterly deliveries exceeded 6 million tons for the first time.
- The Automotive and Special Products segment achieved its best-ever quarterly volumes, supported by OEM approvals for advanced grades from Kalinganagar.
- Branded and Retail segments saw strong growth, with Tata Tiscon achieving record Q3 volumes and the MSME-focused Tata Astrum growing 20% quarter-on-quarter (QoQ).
- NINL recorded a 22% EBITDA margin, with plans for capacity expansion currently awaiting environmental clearance.

European Operations & Regulatory Shifts

- In the Netherlands, EBITDA nearly tripled to €210 million for the 9-month period, despite being weighed down by 50% US tariffs.
- The UK business narrowed its 9-month losses to -£170 million through a £500 million fixed-cost reduction over two years.
- Work is progressing on the 3 million ton scrap-based EAF in the UK, which is critical for the transition to a sustainable, lower-cost operating model.

- EU sentiment is bolstered by the CBAM rollout and expected safeguard revisions in June 2026, which could increase duties on imports from 25% to 50%.

Cost Transformation & Sustainability

- The cost transformation program achieved Rs8,600 crores in savings across geographies over 9 months, reaching 93% compliance with internal plans.
- Savings were driven by purchase optimization, increased use of coastal waterways for logistics, and a leaner coal mix.
- Management remains committed to sustainable steelmaking, commissioning a new production line for packaging steel in the Netherlands using patented chromium coating technology.

Future Outlook & Strategic Expansion

- The company completed the acquisition of a 50.01% stake in Thani Pellets and consolidated its color-coded business.
- Expansion strategy focuses on the East Coast (Odisha) with an opportunity to reach 35 million tons, while a greenfield site in Maharashtra offers optionality for western and southern markets.
- The Ludhiana plant is expected to commence operations by mid-March.
- Management anticipates an EBITDA expansion in Q4 FY26 due to volume growth and cost-takeout benefits, particularly in the Netherlands and India

Financial Summary

Profit & Loss Account

(Rs bn)

Year-end: March	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Net sales	2,434	2,292	2,185	2,386	2,566	2,760
<i>Change (yoy, %)</i>	<i>(0.2)</i>	<i>(5.8)</i>	<i>(4.6)</i>	<i>9.2</i>	<i>7.6</i>	<i>7.6</i>
Operating expenses	(2,111)	(2,069)	(1,932)	(2,035)	(2,140)	(2,310)
EBITDA	323	223	253	351	426	450
<i>Change (yoy, %)</i>	<i>(49.1)</i>	<i>(30.9)</i>	<i>13.4</i>	<i>38.6</i>	<i>21.5</i>	<i>5.6</i>
<i>Margin (%)</i>	<i>13.3</i>	<i>9.7</i>	<i>11.6</i>	<i>14.7</i>	<i>16.6</i>	<i>16.3</i>
Depreciation	(93)	(99)	(104)	(111)	(115)	(119)
EBIT	230	124	149	240	311	331
Interest paid	(63)	(75)	(73)	(75)	(70)	(65)
Other income	10	18	15	15	17	19
Pre-tax profit	182	(11)	84	183	260	286
Tax	(102)	(38)	(52)	(54)	(90)	(99)
<i>Effective tax rate (%)</i>	<i>55.7</i>	<i>(328.0)</i>	<i>62.3</i>	<i>29.7</i>	<i>34.7</i>	<i>34.7</i>
Minority Interest	6.9	4.7	2.5	1.2	0.6	0.3
Net profit	88	(44)	34	130	171	187
Exceptional items	1	(78)	(9)	-	-	-
Adjusted net profit	86	34	43	130	171	187
<i>Change (yoy, %)</i>	<i>(78.5)</i>	<i>(61.0)</i>	<i>26.6</i>	<i>203.4</i>	<i>31.5</i>	<i>9.8</i>
EPS	7.1	2.7	3.4	10.4	13.7	15.0
Dividend per share	3.6	3.6	3.6	3.8	3.8	3.8
<i>Dividend Payout %</i>	<i>50.9</i>	<i>133.1</i>	<i>105.1</i>	<i>36.6</i>	<i>27.8</i>	<i>25.3</i>

Balance Sheet

(Rs bn)

Year-end: March	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Shareholders' funds	1,031	920	912	994	1,117	1,257
Share capital	12	12	12	12	12	12
Reserves & surplus	1,019	908	899	981	1,105	1,244
Total Debt	838	861	938	888	838	788
Other liabilities	283	265	286	298	1,150	1,115
Curr Liab & prov	707	684	657	756	824	856
Current liabilities	668	646	618	717	785	817
Provisions	39	38	39	39	39	39
Total liabilities	1,828	1,810	1,880	1,942	1,936	1,933
Total equity & liabilities	2,880	2,734	2,794	2,938	3,055	3,191
Net fixed assets	1,778	1,832	1,925	1,964	2,000	2,030
Investments	48	55	58	58	58	58
Other non-curr assets	187	142	127	127	127	127
Current assets	867	705	684	789	870	976
Inventories	544	492	446	549	591	635
Sundry Debtors	83	63	53	59	63	68
Cash and Bank	134	87	116	112	147	204
Other current assets	106	64	69	69	69	69
Total assets	2,880	2,734	2,794	2,938	3,055	3,191

Cash Flow Statement

(Rs bn)

Year-end: March	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Pre-tax profit	182	(11)	84	183	260	286
Depreciation	93	99	104	111	115	119
Tax paid	(55)	(53)	(26)	-	-	-
Chg in working capital	(219)	51	(40)	(10)	(16)	(18)
Other operating activities	216	118	113	-	-	-
Cash flow from operations (a)	217	203	235	283	359	388
Capital expenditure	(138)	(177)	(152)	(150)	(150)	(150)
Chg in investments	49	32	2	-	-	-
Other investing activities	(97)	3	8	-	-	-
Cash flow from investing (b)	(187)	(143)	(142)	(150)	(150)	(150)
Equity raised/(repaid)	0	-	-	-	-	-
Debt raised/(repaid)	65	(110)	(176)	(50)	(50)	(50)
Dividend (incl. tax)	(63)	(44)	(45)	(47)	(47)	(47)
Chg in minorities	-	-	-	-	-	-
Other financing activities	(72)	43	151	13	14	15
Cash flow from financing (c)	(70)	(111)	(70)	(85)	(84)	(82)
Net chg in cash (a+b+c)	(40)	(50)	23	49	125	156

Financial Ratios

Year-end: March	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Book Value (Rs)	84	74	73	80	89	101
Adj EPS (Rs)	7.1	2.7	3.4	10.4	13.7	15.0
Adj EPS growth (%)	-78.5	-61.8	26.6	203.4	31.5	9.8
EBITDA margin (%)	13.3	9.7	11.6	14.7	16.6	16.3
Pre-tax margin (%)	7.5	-0.5	3.8	7.7	10.1	10.4
Net Debt/Equity (x)	0.7	0.8	0.9	0.8	0.6	0.5
ROCE (%)	11.1	5.9	7.1	11.0	13.7	13.9
ROE (%)	8.0	3.5	4.7	13.0	15.3	14.9
DuPont Analysis						
Asset turnover (x)	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.9
Leverage factor (x)	2.6	2.9	3.0	3.0	2.7	2.5
Net margin (%)	3.6	1.5	2.0	5.4	6.6	6.8
Working Capital & Liquidity ratio						
Inventory days	82	78	74	84	84	84
Receivable days	12	10	9	9	9	9
Payable days	65	63	55	70	72	72

Valuations

Year-end: March	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
PER (x)	27.8	72.8	57.5	19.0	14.4	13.1
Price/Book value (x)	2.3	2.7	2.7	2.5	2.2	2.0
EV/Net sales (x)	1.3	1.4	1.5	1.4	1.2	1.1
EV/EBITDA (x)	9.6	14.5	13.0	9.2	7.4	6.8
Dividend Yield (%)	1.8	1.8	1.8	1.9	1.9	1.9

Source: Company; IDBI Capital Research

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Most Important Terms and Conditions

1. These terms and conditions, and consent thereon are for the research services provided by the Research Analyst (RA) and RA cannot execute/carry out any trade (purchase/sell transaction) on behalf of, the client. Thus, the clients are advised not to permit RA to execute any trade on their behalf.
2. The fee charged by RA to the client will be subject to the maximum of amount prescribed by SEBI/ Research Analyst Administration and Supervisory Body (RAASB) from time to time (applicable only for Individual and HUF Clients).
Note:
 - 2.1. The current fee limit is Rs 1,51,000/- per annum per family of client for all research services of the RA.
 - 2.2. The fee limit does not include statutory charges.
 - 2.3. The fee limits do not apply to a non-individual client / accredited investor.
3. RA may charge fees in advance if agreed by the client. Such advance shall not exceed the period stipulated by SEBI; presently it is one quarter. In case of pre-mature termination of the RA services by either the client or the RA, the client shall be entitled to seek refund of proportionate fees only for unexpired period.
4. Fees to RA may be paid by the client through any of the specified modes like cheque, online bank transfer, UPI, etc. Cash payment is not allowed. Optionally the client can make payments through Centralized Fee Collection Mechanism (CeFCOM) managed by BSE Limited (i.e. currently recognized RAASB).
5. The RA is required to abide by the applicable regulations/ circulars/ directions specified by SEBI and RAASB from time to time in relation to disclosure and mitigation of any actual or potential conflict of interest. The RA will endeavor to promptly inform the client of any conflict of interest that may affect the services being rendered to the client.
6. Any assured/guaranteed/fixed returns schemes or any other schemes of similar nature are prohibited by law. No scheme of this nature shall be offered to the client by the RA.
7. The RA cannot guarantee returns, profits, accuracy, or risk-free investments from the use of the RA's research services. All opinions, projections, estimates of the RA are based on the analysis of available data under certain assumptions as of the date of preparation/publication of research report.
8. Any investment made based on recommendations in research reports are subject to market risks, and recommendations do not provide any assurance of returns. There is no recourse to claim any losses incurred on the investments made based on the recommendations in the research report. Any reliance placed on the research report provided by the RA shall be as per the client's own judgement and assessment of the conclusions contained in the research report.
9. The SEBI registration, Enlistment with RAASB, and NISM certification do not guarantee the performance of the RA or assure any returns to the client.
10. For any grievances,
 Step 1: the client should first contact the RA using the details on its website or following contact details:
 (RA to provide details as per 'Grievance Redressal / Escalation Matrix')
 Step 2: If the resolution is unsatisfactory, the client can also lodge grievances through SEBI's SCORES platform at www.scores.sebi.gov.in
 Step 3: The client may also consider the Online Dispute Resolution (ODR) through the Smart ODR portal at <https://smartodr.in>
11. Clients are required to keep contact details, including email id and mobile number/s updated with the RA at all times.
12. The RA shall never ask for the client's login credentials and OTPs for the client's Trading Account Demat Account and Bank Account. Never share such information with anyone including RA.